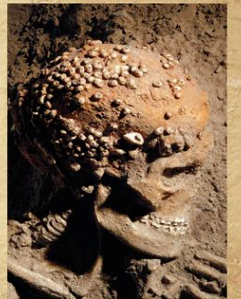


THE OLDEST KNOWN CLAY POTS WERE MADE IN CHINA ABOUT 20,000 YEARS AGO

Earliest burials

Our ancestors began burying their dead with significant objects, such as beads or other decorations, at least 100,000 years ago.

◆ Early burial site



Skull with shells, 25,000 years ago, Balzi Rossi, Italy

Earliest paintings

Humans have painted and carved rock surfaces since at least 40,000 years ago. Some paintings show people dancing and singing.

◆ Early painting site



Inanke Cave, Zimbabwe, 5,000–10,000 years ago

The first sculpture

The earliest known sculpture consists of figurines carved from stone and bone to look like humans and animals. Some date back up to 40,000 years.

◆ Site of artwork

"Lion Man," Germany, 40,000 years ago



Flutes, Hohle Fels Cave, and Geissenklösterle, Germany

● Bisovava, Russia

"Lion Man" bone carving, Germany

◆ Sungir Graves, Russia

Carved ivory running lion, Czech Republic

Tata Plaque (mysterious object made by a Neanderthal 100,000 years ago), Hungary

● Krapina, Croatia

Balzi Rossi caves, Italy

● Tbilisi, Georgia

● Pechka rock shelter, Armenia

◆ Shanidar Cave, Iraq

● Kashafrud, Iran

● Riwat, Pakistan

◆ Bhimbetka paintings, India

● Bose, China

● Bone flutes, Jiahu, China

Carved bone disk, Xiaogushan, China

● Majuangou, China

● Isampur, India

● Island of Socotra, Yemen

● Gona, Ethiopia (world's oldest tools)

● Konso-Gardula, Ethiopia

● Turkana, Kenya

● Lokalalei, Kenya

● Olduvai Gorge, Tanzania

● Omo, Ethiopia

◆ Gebelein, Egypt

● Shell beads, Skhul, Israel

◆ Chauvet Cave, France

◆ Qafzeh, Israel

◆ Twin Rivers, Zambia

◆ Inanke Cave, Zimbabwe

◆ Sterkfontein, South Africa

◆ Swartkrans, South Africa

◆ "Apollo 11" rock shelter, Namibia

◆ Shell beads, Blombos Cave, South Africa

◆ Kakadu National Park, Australia